

Part 1

Read Passage One and answer questions 1-8 on the Question-Answer Book.

Passage One:

- 1 [1] When was the last time you held back your tears? Growing up, many of us, especially boys, have been told crying is a sign of weakness. But Katie Leung Pui-yan, a clinical social worker at Lifespan Counselling, tells us why this couldn't be further from the truth, and that bawling your eyes out is actually an important way to release stress and emotional pain.
- 5 [2] Leung, who is a child and family therapist practising in Hong Kong and Canada, says crying is a perfectly natural reaction to pain or sadness. Crying is an emotional safety valve that prevents us from being overwhelmed by suppressed emotions, which could otherwise lead to depression or other mental health issues.
- 10 [3] "It is a release of the built-up energy deep inside," Leung says. "This is your body's way of soothing itself, and recognising an emotion that you possibly have been feeling for a while but can't quite put a finger on." She says that some of her clients tend to hold back their tears until they voice their feelings. She says that verbally acknowledging the pent-up emotions helps our brain to validate our feelings, which then releases the tears.
- 15 [4] However, the issue is that there is a stigma associated with crying. "When your brain and feelings make a connection, that's when the emotions come and tears flow. But almost instantly the embarrassment comes along: 'Oh my gosh! I can't believe I cried'," Leung says. In particular, Leung says many of her male clients are reluctant to cry as they have been told not to do so since childhood. This is likely due to deep-seated patriarchal beliefs. While this dates back to a time when men were seen as sole protectors of the family and had to "toughen up", this somewhat archaic mentality has been passed down the generations, and, today, many teenage boys are still discouraged from crying.
- 20 [5] "The danger of suppressing all these feelings is that it becomes hard to build connections and meaningful relationships. We bond over vulnerability, and crying is one way for others to see who you are within. When you hold back your feelings, that's when it is hard for others to understand, empathise, and build meaningful connections with you," Leung says. There are other ways aside from crying to share your feelings with others, but vulnerability is key.
- 25 [6] Finding friends you trust will help you feel comfortable enough to take down your guard. Equally important is being that trusted friend who won't judge someone else who is crying. And if you've ever felt ashamed of welling up while reading a sad story or recalling an upsetting incident, Leung says it's time to reframe your negative definition of tears.
- 30 [7] This starts with acknowledging that crying is in our biology, and that a huge part of our brain is focused on emotions. Rather than treating it as an optional reaction, we should regard it as a natural bodily function, just like the need to eat and sleep. With this comes the understanding that we can connect with our inner self through tears. Leung explains that crying your heart out can be a form of self-care. As strange as it may seem, sobbing through a two-hour tear-jerker can be a good way to recalibrate your body and rid your system of negative energy.
- 35 [8] While it is easy for some people to turn on the waterworks, others may have a hard time doing so if they've been in a "drought period". Leung points out that teenagers, especially boys, often struggle to express their emotions, and she suggests speaking to a therapist to find out if there are underlying reasons. On the other hand, if you're crying way too often or are unable to stop, it's also a good idea to seek professional help. If you're used to holding back tears, try reframing your point of view – and don't be afraid of releasing some of that emotion.

Passage Two:

How flavours in instant noodles and other foods are made

- 1 [1] Have you ever wondered how your instant noodles would taste without seasoning powder? Probably just a bland bowl of yellow strings. A pack of Mamee noodles, for example, might taste like crunchy chunks of wood if not for the flavour masters who infuse their magical touch in our food.
- 5 [2] One of such flavourists is Cai Lixin, who works at KH Roberts, a flavour company based in Singapore. A typical day at work for her involves experimenting, creating and altering the taste of foods to give them that extra oomph. "A flavourist basically combines various aroma compounds in very specific proportions," she said. "Think of it as extremely complex chemistry where many ingredients are put together, so that it all comes together into a specific, distinct taste."
- 10 [3] Cai is part of a team that has created the flavours of curry laksa, salted egg and Sichuan spice for instant noodles and other snacks. Among these tastes, she shared that the unmistakable Sichuan mala flavour was the most complicated to create of all. "It was an interesting flavour to build because the overall spicy, pungent notes had to balance the numbing sensation one would get from eating Sichuan peppercorn, chilli and spices," she said. The numbing sensation is very distinct, and lots of work had to be put in to create an authentic mala experience. "Crafting this flavour was definitely a pleasant roller-coaster ride. I am glad to see the flavours we
- 15 enjoy in Asia gaining traction all over the world in different forms," she said. But Cai's job does not stop at concocting new flavours and reproducing popular ones.
- [4] These days, she and her team are working on other projects, including one on perfecting "meaty" flavour for plant-based meat. While meat alternatives have been around for some time, they have often been criticised for their artificial, grassy taste. This is when a flavourist comes into the picture. "Our task is to make plant-based
- 20 meat taste like actual meat products," Cai said. "This all begins with how we perceive flavour. "What we experience from eating or drinking something is actually a combination of olfactory smell and gustatory taste stimulations. Most people assume that our tongue senses all the wonderful flavours when we eat – it is, in fact, our nose's sense of smell." According to Cai, that also explains why we often complain that foods become tasteless when we are down with a cold. Thus, to create the perfect "meatless" meat, its smell must be spot on.
- 25 [5] "We start by identifying the aroma compounds that give pork or chicken their 'meaty' characteristics, and extract them using a gas chromatography mass spectrometer," Cai said. "Similar aroma compounds from non-animal origins are then tested and replicated in the lab. There is lots of other work involved, of course."
- [6] To pass the taste test, Cai needs to add another layer of the aroma of cooked meat. She also uses other compounds to cover the unpalatable taste of plant-based protein ingredients. "There is no one correct way to do
- 30 this. It's really a test of a flavourist's creativity and skills ... of course, our immaculate sense of taste and smell too," she explained. "Whenever I taste something new, I'll immediately think about how the flavour can be reinvented." She added that the ability to tell apart minute sensory details – such as woody, lemony or robust – is key to creating complex flavours.
- [7] To ensure her senses are in tip-top condition, she starts her mornings with a clean palate by staying away
- 35 from food and drinks that are too strong. Skipping a morning cup of coffee to taste hundreds of random flavourings might seem like a sacrifice to some. But Cai said she felt otherwise. "My job has brought me a different level of appreciation and enjoyment for foods and beverages," said the flavourist. "I hope to continue reimagining the possibilities of flavours and continue to craft new ones that others will enjoy as much as I do."

END OF READING PASSAGES



FORM 2

GENERAL ENGLISH

QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK

Name: _____

Class: _____

Class Number: _____

Set 5

Part 1 – Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

For each multiple-choice question, darken the appropriate circle. Otherwise, no mark will be awarded.

Passage One (14 marks)

1. Find a four-word phrase in Paragraph 3 which means to discover the exact reason why a situation is the way it is.

2. What does 'archaic mentality' (line 17) refer to?

3. Find a word in paragraphs 4 to 6 which shares the same meaning as each of the phrases below. (4 marks)

(i) a strong feeling of disapproval that most people in a society have about something _____

(ii) unwilling to do something _____

(iii) the quality of being able to be easily hurt or influenced _____

(iv) to change the way something is expressed or considered _____

4. According to Paragraph 7, what is the similarity between crying and the need to eat and sleep?

5. To share your feelings, you are advised to find _____.

- (i) someone who is older than you
- (ii) someone whom you believe and feel comfortable with
- (iii) someone who is judgemental about crying
- (iv) someone who has trouble expressing emotions

- A. (ii) only
- B. (i) and (ii) only
- C. (ii) and (iii) only
- D. (iii) and (iv) only

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

6. Match each of the following comments with a person mentioned in the text. Write the letter of the comment next to the person given. One comment is **NOT** used. Each letter can be used **ONCE** only. (3 marks)

- A. After undergoing therapy, I learned to voice my feelings and release my tears.
 B. Shedding a few tears can help release stress and emotional pain, safeguarding against depression.
 C. I suppress my feelings because my parents told me to.
 D. You should hold it all in. Letting out your emotions makes you weak.
 E. Pretending to be happy can sometimes build meaningful connections.

(i) Katie Leung Pui-yan		(ii) Teenage boys	
(iii) Clients		Old generations e.g.	D

7. According to Paragraph 8, under which two conditions should people seek professional help? (2 marks)

8. Which of the following is the best title for the article?

- A. Crying is an optional reaction
 B. Why crying is good for your mental health
 C. Cry only when you are vulnerable
 D. Teenage boys and their emotions

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Passage Two (16 marks)

9. Find one word in Paragraph 2 to replace 'flavour masters' (line 3)?

10. Is the Sichuan mala flavour easy to create? Provide evidence from the text to support your answer.

11. Based on the article, what is lacking in plant-based meat?

- A. an authentic taste
 B. an artificial taste
 C. certain proteins
 D. all of the above

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

12. Apart from our sense of taste, which other sense do we use when tasting food?

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

13. Which of the following foods is Cai most likely to take for breakfast before she goes to work?

- A. kimchi fried rice
- B. whole wheat toast with butter
- C. curry laksa
- D. coffee with milk

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

14. Below are the steps that Cai takes to make plant-based meat taste like real chicken. In two of the lines, there is ONE mistake. If you find a mistake, underline the mistake and replace the word with one that expresses the correct idea. Write the word in the space on the right. If there is no mistake, put a tick (✓) in the space. The first has been done for you. (3 marks)

	Step	Correction
e.g.	1. Analyse real chicken and pick out its meaty <u>protein</u> compounds.	aroma
(i)	2. Draw out the meaty aroma compounds using special equipment.	
(ii)	3. Run tests on comparable aroma compounds that are not made from plants.	
(iii)	4. Add a layer of uncooked meat aroma to mask the taste of plant-based protein ingredients.	

15. Use the information in the article to decide whether the following statements are True, False or Not Given. (3 marks)

- (i) Cai has produced popular flavours like salted egg on her own.
- (ii) It is more difficult to create Sichuan spice than plant-based meat taste.
- (iii) Flavour makers are not allowed to reinvent flavours in innovative ways.

T F NG
○ ○ ○
○ ○ ○
○ ○ ○

16. What is Cai's tone in Paragraph 7?

- A. annoyed
- B. worried
- C. enthusiastic
- D. neutral

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

17. Oscar is writing a summary of the article. Please help him complete the following paragraph. Use only ONE word in each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct. (4 marks)

From her (i) _____ in Singapore, Cai Lixin has created (ii) _____ for foods – such as instant noodles and other snacks – that have travelled the world. She reveals how difficult it is to make (iii) _____ meat taste like the real thing, and why her job requires her to (iv) _____ her morning cup of coffee.

END OF PART 1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Part 2 – English Usage (70 marks)

A. Verb Forms (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the words provided in brackets in their correct forms.

Hello Kitty's Charming Secret

To be exact, Hello Kitty's birthday was on 1 November, 1974. The fictional character (1) (create) by Yuko Shimizu for Japanese gift enterprise Sanrio, and first (2) (appear) on vinyl coin purses. Since then, Kitty (3) (gain) phenomenal worldwide popularity, collecting fans that transcend geographical, ethnic and generational boundaries.

Commercially, Hello Kitty is, no doubt, an epic global success. The brand logo has adorned products of all conceivable kinds. It has been suggested that if you (4) (not know) Hello Kitty, you have probably been living under a rock.

Formula of success

With her feline features and oversized red bow on her forehead, Hello Kitty is obviously very lovable, even if her white moon face (5) (disclose) no emotion. She has been described as "a cultural and marketing juggernaut on equal footing to icons such as Mickey Mouse and Count Chocula".

What (6) (be) the appeal of this "five apples high" little girl with no mouth, who can outshine so many other cartoon icons? Any product or brand that has achieved such worldwide popularity must inevitably be indebted to globalisation, and Hello Kitty is no exception.

No identity is a good identity

Unlike Snoopy or Doraemon, Hello Kitty was not born as a comic or manga character, but purely as a brand logo design. Her creator only gave her a sketchy background. On Sanrio's Hello Kitty main page, the description is: Hello Kitty "lives in the suburbs of London with her parents and twin sister Mimmy, who is her best friend. Her hobbies include baking cookies and (7) (make) new friends. As she always (8) (say), 'You can never have too many friends'. Her "real name" is listed as "Kitty White"; blood type: "A".

Vagueness, in this case, is malleability, which is clearly a marketing advantage for Hello Kitty, making it easy for people (9) (love) her irrespective of their cultural heritage and ethnicity. It also lets her (10) (adopt) an unlimited number of personas – from Statue of Liberty Kitty to Native American and veiled Indian beauty.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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B. Vocabulary (5 marks)

Choose the most suitable words from the table below to complete the passage. You may need to change the form of some words. Each word should only be used once.

trivial	forbid	celebrate
compliment	berate	oblivious
advancement	profuse	confront

'Look at this, mommy. Aunt Jessica is wearing a birthday hat, but why is she crying? Did the teacher (1) her?' Lily asked.

When I looked at this old photo, childhood memories came flooding back. It may have been a (2) incident, but it is etched in my heart. 'It was October, Jessica's birthday month. She had just turned three and I was five. It was the tradition of our kindergarten to hold a monthly birthday (3) for the birthday stars. During teatime, the birthday stars took photos and everybody got the chance to have some birthday cake. As usual, Jessica and I brought our own utensils. But that day, grandma accidentally switched our cups while packing our school bags.'

'How did you find out?'

'They were different in colour. Mine was yellow and Jessica's was red. So it was quite obvious, but we remained (4) to the blunder until teatime.'

'I bet you two reacted very differently.'

'You're right. I couldn't have cared less. Despite the colour difference, the cups were exactly the same. I was stunned when the teacher brought my little sister to my classroom after her birthday photo, which is the one you are holding now. Jessica insisted on exchanging the cups. She was crying (5).'

'That says a lot about you both!' Lily and I both burst into laughter.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

C. Parts of Speech (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate forms of the words in brackets.

Financial knowledge pays dividends to society

Knowing how to handle money is an (1) (essence) skill for young people, and there are plenty of opportunities for banks to teach it through workshops delivered by employee (2) (voluntary).

Banks' social responsibility

Financial institutions are becoming more and more aware of their social responsibility to contribute to the long-term and sustainable (3) (growing) of communities they have footprints in. Helping communities build their financial capability is one area in which the industry can (4) (directed) contribute. The (5) (early) in life a person receives financial education, the more effective it is, as a large part of financial education is about taking time to instil the right mindset. In 2013, Standard Chartered kick-started a tailor-made financial education programme for the youths of Hong Kong. In (6) (development) economies such as Hong Kong, young people's (7) (able) to manage their personal finances (8) (sense) and effectively needs to be boosted so that they can navigate through the material world.

Financial workshops

In the workshops, students list their 'needs' ranging from the tangible, such as a flat to live in, to the intangible, such as friendship; and their 'wants', from the latest smartphone to entrance qualifications for a local basketball (9) (competitor). Combining financial literacy with career guidance, such training not only equips youths with the skills to manage their money, but also plants the seeds of financial literacy in them so that when they grow up they will become (10) (finance) responsible citizens.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.	6.	7.	8.
9.	10.		

D. Articles (5 marks)

Complete the following passage by inserting the most appropriate article ('a', 'an', 'the' or an 'X' where no article is needed) in each of the blanks.

Junk food such as chips, soft drinks and chocolate are accused of being (1) leading cause of many health problems, such as obesity, diabetes, liver ailments and cancer because they are high in salt, sugar, oil, fat, food colouring and preservatives.

To combat this problem, (2) US and European countries such as Denmark, France and England are imposing (3) additional taxes on junk food. The World Health Organisation (WHO) has called for concerted efforts between governments and food industries to limit the sale of junk food in schools and regulate advertising targeted at kids. It seems like (4) international anti-junk food campaign has started in (5) full swing. In accordance with the guidelines given by WHO, more countries have stepped up the regulation of junk food to tackle the heaving junk food imports and marketing.

1.	2.	3.	4.
5.			

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

E. Conditionals (10 marks)

Based on the situations given, rewrite the following sentences using conditionals. You may have to change the tense of the verbs.

1. Louis plans to buy a car for his parents but he is poor. He will need to make enough money.

If _____

2. The machine operates at its highest speed every time you press the button.

If _____

3. Alex wants to join the running race but he does not have time for running practice.

If _____

4. I want to catch villains and save the world, but I am not a superhero.

If _____

5. Phoebe wants to watch the musical. She needs to book the tickets weeks in advance.

If _____

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

F. Multiple-choice Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following text. Decide which of the choices would best complete the text if inserted in the blanks. Write the **letter** of each answer in the space provided.

Celebrating the first human in space on Yuri's Night

On this day, 60 years ago, Russian cosmonaut Yuri Gagarin became the first human to travel to space. To remember this amazing pilot and his ground-breaking feat, Yuri's Night is a (1) event that began (2) the 40th anniversary of Gagarin's launch.

This day also (3) the celebration for other space milestones as well, making it a party day on the International Space Station (ISS). Beginning in 1962, it was celebrated as Cosmonautics Day in the USSR and continues now in Russia. In 2011, the day became recognised across the world as the International Day of Human Space Flight.

Yuri's Night, also known as "The World Space Party", was created in 2001 by people in the US space industry. It aims to explore the cosmos with music, (4), science, culture and each other, according to their website.

Space exploration has come (5) since Gagarin first made his rugged orbit of our planet. Since 1961, we've discovered lots more about space. In 1990, the Hubble Space Telescope was launched and changed our basic understanding of the universe. We found more places to travel to: exoplanets, twin stars, nebulae, and more.

We have our first direct photo of a black hole. China made a soft (6) on the far side of the Moon, where we had the first-ever seeds grown on the moon. (7), Nasa engineers are working on a mini helicopter that will fly on Mars! We've put rovers on asteroids, grown lettuce on the ISS, flown by Pluto, and found water – almost everywhere, it seems. We've even seen a weird visitor from deep space.

'Oumuamua is the first thing we've ever noticed passing through our solar system. It was discovered by Robert Weryk using an observatory telescope in the US state of Hawaii. At first, we didn't know what it was, and we discussed (8) or not it might be an alien spaceship. Was it some extraterrestrial Gagarin making their first flight towards us? As it turned out, most (9) not.

Closer to home, the Daniel K. Inouye Solar Telescope in Hawaii, the biggest solar telescope in the world, gave us a close-up of our own sun. It showed us that the sun's surface seems to be made (10) golden nuggets which are about the size of France!

1. A. annual B. annually C. year D. yearly	2. A. in B. on C. from D. for	3. A. marks B. starts C. passes D. breaks
4. A. artisan B. art C. artistic D. artists	5. A. a heavy way B. a difficult way C. a hard way D. a long way	6. A. landing B. opening C. launch D. manner
7. A. One day B. Formerly C. Currently D. Once	8. A. if B. whether C. in case D. regardless	9. A. probably B. properly C. perhaps D. maybe
10. A. from B. by C. with D. up of		

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

G. Prepositions (10 marks)

Fill in the blanks with the correct prepositions.

Science mysteries made easy

Bill Bryson's popular science book is a remarkable tour through Earth's history: (1) the Big Bang to the rise (2) civilisation

As a child, Bill Bryson was fascinated (3) a cutaway diagram showing the Earth's interior (what the Earth would look like if you sliced it like a cake). He eagerly read the words that went with it and was mind-numbingly bored and confused by the science. (4) his great disappointment the book did not tell him why we ended (5) with a sun inside our planet or why the ground was not hot. We all know that textbook authors are not the most creative (6) writers and they managed (7) turn Bryson off science, for a time.

Driven by his childhood experiences with dry and boring science textbooks he set (8) to write his own science book; one that would answer the questions that interested him. And so he has. A Short History of Nearly Everything does manage to cover nearly everything. But what makes this book different is Bryson's clear and easy-to-understand writing style.

This book is a fun read; Bryson is excited and interested (9) what makes our Earth tick. He is curious how we managed to survive the lucky draw of evolution to get where we are today and manages to convey all this history and science into a collection (10) strange and compelling tales.

1.	2.	3.	4.	5.
6.	7.	8.	9.	10.

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H. Proofreading (10 marks)

Proofread the following text (numbered lines 1-10 only) without changing the meaning. No lines have more than one mistake and at least one line is correct. Do not make any changes to punctuation and do not make unnecessary changes. Use ONE word only for each correction. If you think there are no mistakes in a line, put a ✓ at the end of the line (example c).

Corrections must be done as follows:

Extra word: delete the extra word with a 'X' (example a).

Missing word: mark the position of the missing word with a '^' and write the missing word above it (example b).

Wrong word: underline the wrong word and write the correct word above it (example d).

a	When I was younger, my friends and I would X try to scare each other
b	by telling ghost stories. I never got frightened because I did not believe ^ ghosts.
c	In fact, I would laugh at anyone who said they did. However, I changed my ✓
d	mind about this last summer when I was staying <u>at</u> my aunt in Guangzhou.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

- 1 *Jurassic Park*, the very first film of the series, was adapted from a science fiction novel by America writer
- 2 Michael Crichton. Many of you may know the story of the movie, which in fact is similar with to that of the
- 3 novel – scientists bring dinosaurs back to life by recreate damaged dinosaur DNA. The book, published
- 4 in 1990, was successfully adapted into a film by Steven Spielberg in 1993.
- 5 Crichton's books most consist of cautionary tales, scientific developments that usually lead to either
- 6 disaster nor misfortune. You might assume that he was anti-technology, but in fact he was not. In Crichton's
- 7 books there are usually some well-educated, sane characters. They argue that failures or crashes are a
- 8 inevitable stage in science and the advancement of technology. Crichton argues that human beings should
- 9 always be aware of the effects of our scientific research and be prepared the consequences, including
- 10 worse case scenarios.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

END OF PAPER

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.